

P1 - Graphic Standards Manual

ARC 3133-001 / Architectural Visualization Methods 1 / Fall 2026 - Full Term

Approach: Graphic standards

Revision: 2026-09-23. Instructor review draft. Grading allocation approved; dates remain proposed for review before publication.

1 - Graphic Standards Manual

Introduced: Week 1 - Aug 25 / **Due:** Week 9 - Oct 20, 11:59 PM Eastern Time / **Weight:** 5%

Preparation checks: Week 2 - Sep 1: Bring a sample sheet for an ungraded identity check.; Final review - December 10-16, 2026; exact review slot to be confirmed: Submit the revised manual as a separate PDF alongside the booklet.

Description

Make a Graphic Standards Manual that someone else could use to reproduce the layouts and drawing style of your course work. Give every setting as a number and show each rule in use. Apply it to all assignments and the final booklet, and revise it after critique.

Rules & Constraints

- Make exactly four pages. Show each graphic rule beside a tested application.
- Use one page each for: (1) sheet size, margins, grid, columns and placement; (2) typography and hierarchy; (3) color and line weights; (4) annotations, captions and image treatment on a course sheet.
- Use at most three typefaces, two colors plus a dark or white background, four hierarchy levels and four line weights.
- Study the NYCTA, NASA and Munich 1972 manuals linked under Reading and documentation. Name one rule you adopted.
- Apply the manual to all assignments and the final booklet, and revise it after critique.

Parameters

- Page: 17 inches wide x 11 inches high, landscape. State margins, column count, gutter width, alignment guides and the positions of the title, caption and footer.
- Type: identify the family, style, point size and leading for each hierarchy level. Use at most three typefaces and four hierarchy levels.
- Color: give HEX or RGB values and a role for each color. Use up to two colors plus a dark or white background. Explain how you chose the palette (for example, complementary or analogous colors). If you start from a triadic scheme, name the two hues you kept.
- Line: set up to four line weights, in points or millimeters, and say what each is for. Distinguish final edges, secondary detail and construction lines. State how you use dashed lines, if you do.

Required Studies

- **Page 1 - Sheet system.** Show the 17 x 11 inch grid with dimensioned margins, columns and gutters. Place a small drawing in the grid to demonstrate alignment. Include course, student, assignment and page information in a consistent location.
- **Page 2 - Typography.** Show the hierarchy with real titles, body text, drawing labels and captions. Print the settings beside each specimen so another person can reproduce them.
- **Page 3 - Color and line weights.** Include labeled swatches, HEX or RGB values, the background and a short explanation of your palette. Apply the line hierarchy to a piece of a real drawing - isolated strokes don't show which edges get which weight. Check the drawing in grayscale.
- **Page 4 - Applied course sheet.** Use your own course work to demonstrate annotations, captions and image treatment. Show a main drawing and supporting process views with a clear reading order. Include the reference manual and one rule you adopted. Do not add a separate cover.

Workflow

1. Study the NYCTA, NASA and Munich 1972 manuals linked in Reading and documentation. Pick one rule and see how its diagram and its application match.
2. Set the grid, type, palette and line styles as numbers in an editable layout or drawing program. Template-based design tools can't be used for this work.
3. Apply the settings to real drawings, then check every page against the rules you wrote. Replace placeholder content and credit outside sources.
4. Check the exported PDF at actual size and make a test print. Fix fine lines, small captions or weak contrast before you submit.

Deliverables

- **Exactly four 17 x 11 inch landscape pages** in Lastname_Firstname_GSM.pdf, in the order above. Export sharp linework and legible, selectable text where possible.
- **Editable layout file** with linked images packaged. Keep the grid and named styles ready for later course sheets.
- Submit the PDF and the layout file in Lastname_Firstname_GSM/, where announced in class or on Canvas. Bring a sample sheet to the Week 2 check, and submit the revised manual separately with the final booklet.

Evaluation

- **Visual quality and hierarchy - 40%:** drawings, supporting information and captions have a clear reading order and are legible at actual size.
- **Consistency and usability - 30%:** every rule has a value, a unit and a use; someone else could reproduce the system.
- **Tested applications - 20%:** real drawings demonstrate the documented grid, typography, palette and line weights.
- **Completeness - 10%:** all four pages and editable assets are present and free of export errors.

Before You Submit

- [] Four pages only, all 17 x 11 inches, in the required order.
- [] No more than three typefaces, two colors plus a dark or white background, four hierarchy levels and four line weights. Either HEX or RGB values and the palette strategy are provided.
- [] Every standard has a numerical setting and a tested application.
- [] One adopted precedent rule is named and credited.
- [] The PDF and editable source open from the submission folder.

Shared standards: Course software, fabrication, attribution and AI policies apply. Submit through the channel announced in class/Canvas. Test the packaged source from a clean folder. Percentages follow the instructor review draft. This handout uses US Letter; student sheets are 17 x 11 inches.

Midterm grade: The midterm grade accumulates the Graphic Standards Manual, CSG sheet and print, module (3.1) and arrays (3.2). These assignments account for 40% of the final course grade. Report the accumulated result as a percentage of those 40 possible course points. The midterm adds no separate assessment weight.